

INVESTIGATION 4.1

Mapping your organs

AIM To draw a diagram to map out the positions and shapes of some human body organs

Materials:

large sheets of paper (e.g. butcher paper)

pencils and marker pens

sticky tape

scissors

optional: light coloured material, sewing thread and needle (or stapler or craft glue), 'stuffing', various other bright coloured materials

METHOD AND RESULTS

- ▶ Use the sticky tape to join the paper together so that it is the size of a student body outline.
- ▶ One member of the team lies down on the paper with their arms away from their body.



- 1 Another team member carefully draws (about 5 cm away from their body) an outline of their partner's body.
- ▶ Once the outline is drawn, the person on the paper can join the rest of the team for the remainder of the activity.
- ▶ As a team, decide where in the body outline the following organs are located: heart, lungs, small intestine, nose,

oesophagus, liver, stomach, ears, kidney, large intestine, pancreas, eyes, bladder, brain, trachea, mouth.

- ▶ Once the location of each organ has been agreed upon, discuss their shape and size.
- 2 Once consensus is reached within the group, draw each of these organs onto the paper body outline.



- ▶ Compare your diagram to reference materials to judge its accuracy.
 - 3 Using these references as a guide, use different coloured pens to draw in more accurate organ shapes, sizes or locations onto your paper body outline.
- Optional: Use the final version of your organ body outline as a pattern to make human body organ stuffed toys or a human body organ blanket.

DISCUSS AND EXPLAIN

- 4 (a) How accurate was your team's first attempt at drawing the body organ outline?
(b) Which organs were located correctly and which were not?
(c) How closely did your team's estimate of shape and size compare to that referenced for each organ?
- 5 Identify the system to which each of the organs on your outline belong.
- 6 As an individual learner, identify which organs had a size, shape and location that you expected and which did not. Summarise what you have learned about human body organs in this investigation.